

Absolutely — **sister** is useful, though unlike words such as **range** or **colour**, its core lexical polysemy is relatively compact. The main useful extensions come from **family relationship**, female members of groups/orders, metaphorical “sister” relationships between organizations/places, and related compounds.

Word family: **sister / sisterly / sisterhood**

Base word: sister

Plural: sisters

Related forms: sisterly, sisterhood

Useful compounds / extensions: older sister, younger sister, sister company, sister city, sister school, sister ship

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / adjective-like attributive use (名詞作前置修飾語)

Your passage:

> “She is my mother’s older **sister**...”

Meaning in your passage: **sister** = female sibling — 姐妹；姐姐 / 妹妹

Here **sister** means:

> **a female person who has the same parent or parents as another person.**

繁體中文：

與某人有相同父母之一或全部相同父母的女性手足；姐妹

In your exact sentence:

> “my mother’s older sister”

= **我媽媽的姐姐**

So the natural translation is:

> “She is my mother’s older sister.”

「她是我媽媽的**姐姐**。」

1. **sister** = female sibling (家庭) — 姐妹；姐姐 / 妹妹

The core everyday meaning.

Practice 1

> “She has two **sisters**.”

「她有兩個**姐妹**。」

Practice 2

> “My older sister lives abroad.”

「我的**姐姐**住在外國。」

sister = 女性手足；實際翻譯要按年齡關係譯作姐姐 / 妹妹

Important:

English **sister** itself does not tell you whether she is older or younger.

2. **older sister / elder sister — 姐姐**

Practice 3

> “She is my **older sister**.”

「她是我的**姐姐**。」

Practice 4

> “His elder sister works in a hospital.”

「他的**姐姐**在醫院工作。」

older/elder sister = 年紀比說話者 / 相關手足大的女性手足

Usage note:

* **older sister** is the most common everyday form.

* **elder sister** is correct but more traditional/formal in many contexts.

3. **younger sister — 妹妹**

Practice 5

> “My **younger sister** is still at university.”

「我的**妹妹**還在讀大學。」

Practice 6

> “She often helps her younger sister with homework.”

「她經常幫**妹妹**做功課。」

younger sister = 年紀較小的女性手足

4. **half-sister — 同父異母 / 同母異父的姐妹**

A useful family relationship term.

Practice 7

> “She has a **half-sister** from her father’s second marriage.”

「她有一個父親再婚後所生的**同父異母姐妹**。」

Practice 8

> “They share the same mother, so they are half-sisters.”

「她們有同一位母親，所以是**同母異父姐妹**。」

half-sister = 與某人只共有一名親生父母的女性手足

5. **stepsister — 繼姐妹**

Practice 9

> “His **stepsister** moved in last year.”

「他的**繼姐妹**去年搬了進來。」

Practice 10

> “They became stepsisters after their parents married.”

「她們的父母結婚後，她們成為了**繼姐妹**。」

****stepsister = 因父母再婚而形成、沒有共同親生父母的女性繼親手足****

6. ****sister = female member of a religious order (宗教) — 修女；女修士****

A genuinely distinct lexical meaning.

Practice 11

> “The ****sisters**** run a small school.”

「那些****修女****經營一所小學校。」

Practice 12

> “She became a Sister at a young age.”

「她年輕時成為了****修女****。」

****Sister = 某些基督宗教修會中的女性成員****

When used as a title, ****Sister**** is capitalized.

Example:

> Sister Mary

= 瑪利修女

7. ****sister = female colleague/member in a shared cause/group — 姊妹；女性同伴****

A social/solidarity use.

Practice 13

> “She thanked her union ****sisters**** for their support.”

「她感謝工會中的女性****姊妹 / 同伴****支持她。」

Practice 14

> “The group encourages solidarity among sisters.”

「這個團體鼓勵女性成員之間的**姊妹情誼**。」

****sister = 因共同身份、團體或目標而彼此視為姊妹的女性成員****

This is contextual and often symbolic rather than biological.

8. ****sister company (商業) — 姊妹公司；關聯公司****

A major business compound.

Practice 15

> “The hotel is owned by a ****sister company****.”

「這間酒店由一家****姊妹公司 / 關聯公司****擁有。」

Practice 16

> “The two firms are sister companies under the same group.”

「兩家公司都是同一集團旗下的****姊妹公司****。」

****sister company = 與另一家公司有相同母公司 / 集團關係的公司****

9. ****sister organization / sister institution — 姊妹機構；關聯機構****

Practice 17

> “The museum works with a ****sister institution**** overseas.”

「這間博物館與海外一間****姊妹機構****合作。」

Practice 18

> “The charities are sister organizations.”

「這些慈善機構是互相關聯的****姊妹機構****。」

****sister organization = 與另一機構在結構、合作或母體關係上密切相關的組織****

10. ****sister city / twin city (城市) — 姊妹城市 ; 友好城市****

Practice 19

> “The two cities became ****sister cities**** in 1995.”

「兩座城市在 1995 年結為****姊妹城市 / 友好城市****。」

Practice 20

> “The exchange programme was organized through the sister-city relationship.”

「交流計劃透過兩地的****姊妹城市關係****安排。」

****sister city = 與另一城市建立正式友好 / 文化交流關係的城市****

11. ****sister school (教育) — 姊妹學校****

Practice 21

> “Our school has a ****sister school**** in Japan.”

「我們學校在日本有一所****姊妹學校****。」

Practice 22

> “Students visited their sister school during the exchange.”

「學生交流期間到訪了****姊妹學校****。」

****sister school = 與另一學校建立正式合作、交流或伙伴關係的學校****

12. ****sister ship (航運) — 姊妹船 ; 同型船****

A useful technical/general compound.

Practice 23

> “The vessel has two ****sister ships****.”

「這艘船有兩艘****姊妹船 / 同型船****。」

Practice 24

> “Its sister ship was launched a year later.”

「它的****姊妹船****一年後下水。」

****sister ship = 與另一艘船設計、級別或建造系列相同 / 密切相關的船****

13. ****sister publication / sister channel (媒體) — 姊妹刊物；姊妹頻道****

Practice 25

> “The magazine shares content with its ****sister publication****.”

「這本雜誌與其****姊妹刊物****共享內容。」

Practice 26

> “The programme also airs on a sister channel.”

「這個節目也會在其****姊妹頻道****播出。」

****sister + organization/media = 與另一單位同屬一個集團、品牌或密切關聯體系****

This is productive, so we do not need to list every possible noun.

14. ****sisterly = like a sister / showing affection between sisters — 姊妹般的；姊妹情深的****

Practice 27

> “She gave me some ****sisterly advice****.”

「她給了我一些****像姐姐般關心的建議****。」

Practice 28

> “There was a strong sisterly bond between them.”

「她們之間有很深的**姊妹情誼**。」

sisterly = 像姐妹之間一樣帶有關愛、支持或親密感的

15. **sisterhood = relationship/bond among sisters — 姊妹關係；姊妹情誼**

Practice 29

> “They valued their **sisterhood**.”

「她們很珍惜彼此的**姊妹情誼**。」

Practice 30

> “Years apart did not weaken their sisterhood.”

「多年分離也沒有削弱她們的**姊妹感情**。」

sisterhood = 姐妹之間的關係、感情和共同身份

16. **sisterhood = solidarity among women — 女性團結；姊妹情誼**

A broader social meaning.

Practice 31

> “The event celebrated **sisterhood** and mutual support.”

「活動慶祝女性之間的**姊妹情誼與互相支持**。」

Practice 32

> “The group promotes a sense of sisterhood.”

「這個團體提倡女性之間的**團結與姊妹情誼**。」

sisterhood = 女性因共同經驗、身份或目標而形成的團結與支持關係

17. **sisterhood = community/order of nuns — 女修會；修女團體**

A distinct religious meaning.

Practice 33

> “She joined a small **sisterhood** devoted to education.”

「她加入了一個致力教育的小型**女修會**。」

Practice 34

> “The sisterhood runs several charities.”

「這個**修女團體**經營數個慈善機構。」

sisterhood = 由修女 / 女性宗教成員組成的宗教團體

Important distinction: **sister** vs **sibling**

sister

specifically female sibling.

sibling

gender-neutral:

brother or sister.

> “I have two siblings.”

= 我有兩個兄弟姊妹。

So:

> sister = 姐妹

> sibling = 兄弟姊妹 / 手足

Important distinction: **sister** vs **cousin**

sister

shares at least one parent with you.

cousin

usually child of your aunt/uncle.

> sister = 姐 / 妹

> cousin = 表 / 堂兄弟姊妹

Important distinction: **older sister vs elder sister**

older sister

most common everyday wording.

elder sister

more traditional/formal and normally used before the noun.

You can say:

> my elder sister

but not normally:

> *She is elder than me.*

Instead:

> She is older than me.

Important distinction: **sister vs nun**

nun

general noun for a woman belonging to a religious community.

Sister

can be the title/address used for such a woman.

> Sister Maria

> = 瑪利亞修女

Not every religious tradition uses the titles in exactly the same way, but this distinction is useful.

Important distinction: **sister company vs subsidiary**

sister companies

usually share the same parent/group.

subsidiary

is owned/controlled by a parent company.

So two subsidiaries of the same parent may be **sister companies** to each other.

Important distinction: **sister city vs nearby city**

A **sister city** does not mean a geographically nearby city.

It means:

> a city with a formal partnership/relationship.

So two sister cities may be on different continents.

Important distinction: **sisterhood vs friendship**

friendship

general relationship between friends.

sisterhood

emphasizes:

- * female solidarity;
- * family-like bond;
- * shared identity/experience.

They overlap emotionally but are not synonyms.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * **sister — female sibling** = 姐妹
- * **older/elder sister** = 姐姐
- * **younger sister** = 妹妹
- * **half-sister** = 同父異母 / 同母異父姐妹
- * **stepsister** = 繼姐妹
- * **Sister — religious title/member** = 修女
- * **sister — symbolic female colleague/member** = 姊妹 / 女性同伴
- * **sister company** = 姊妹公司
- * **sister organization/institution** = 姊妹機構
- * **sister city** = 姊妹城市 / 友好城市
- * **sister school** = 姊妹學校
- * **sister ship** = 姊妹船 / 同型船
- * **sister + media/organization** = 同集團 / 密切關聯單位
- * **sisterly** = 姊妹般的
- * **sisterhood — family bond** = 姊妹情誼
- * **sisterhood — female solidarity** = 女性團結 / 姊妹情誼
- * **sisterhood — religious community** = 女修會 / 修女團體

This is a relatively compact family, so I would stop here rather than force rare historical or technical uses.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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sister — family	與某人共有至少一名親生父母的女性手足
older/elder sister	年紀較大的女性手足；姐姐
younger sister	年紀較小的女性手足；妹妹
half-sister	與某人只共有一名親生父母的女性手足
stepsister	因父母再婚形成、沒有共同親生父母的女性繼親手足
Sister — religion	某些基督宗教修會中的女性成員 / 修女稱謂
sister — solidarity	因共同身份、團體或目標而彼此視作姊妹的女性成員
sister company	與另一家公司同屬一個母公司 / 集團的關聯公司
sister city	與另一城市建立正式友好、文化交流關係的城市
sister school	與另一學校建立正式合作 / 交流關係的學校
sister ship	與另一艘船屬同型、同級或同系列的船
sisterly	像姐妹之間一樣帶有關愛、支持或親密感的
sisterhood — family	姐妹之間的關係與感情

| **sisterhood — social** | 女性因共同身份 / 經驗而形成的團結與支持 |
| **sisterhood — religious** | 由女性宗教成員組成的修女團體 / 女修會 |

For your original sentence

> “She is my mother’s older **sister**...”

The exact meaning is:

sister = 與我媽媽有共同父母的女性手足；因為她年紀較大，所以是「姐姐」

So:

> **my mother’s older sister**

= **「我媽媽的姐姐」**

Natural full translation:

> **「她是我媽媽的姐姐。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

> **sister** → 姐妹
> **older sister** → 姐姐
> **younger sister** → 妹妹
> **half-sister** → 同父異母 / 同母異父姐妹
> **stepsister** → 繼姐妹
> **Sister** → 修女
> **sister company** → 姊妹公司
> **sister city** → 姊妹城市
> **sisterly** → 姊妹般的
> **sisterhood** → 姊妹情誼 / 女性團結